

AKASH SHARMA

Product Manager | Fintech Wallets & AI Products

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product Manager with 2+ years of product experience across fintech, AI, and edtech, now building ZikPe, a travel and UPI wallet app, end-to-end from inception - owning PRDs and feature specs, KYC onboarding, and corporate card strategy while prototyping hands-on with AI coding tools. Fluent in SQL and data-driven decision-making; comfortable discussing high- and low-level design (HLD/LLD) with engineers. Co-author of IEEE-published research on fraud detection in payment systems.

EXPERIENCE

Product Manager - ZikPe | Zikzuk | Jun 2026 - Present

- Core product team member building ZikPe, a travel and UPI wallet app, from inception - spanning product strategy, requirements, design, development, and go-to-market across the full product cycle.
- Own PRDs and feature specs end-to-end, translating product strategy into actionable requirements for engineering and design.
- Contribute hands-on code and interface design, turning product ideas into working prototypes and app experiences alongside product management responsibilities.
- Drive KYC onboarding strategy with multiple vendors, spanning identity-verification integration planning and compliance requirements.
- Shape corporate card strategy and product development, including tax-benefit cards and fuel cards.
- Drive product marketing in a startup environment, including helping select the ZikPe name.

AI Product Manager Intern | Mactores, Bengaluru | Sep 2025 - Mar 2026

- Translated business requirements into analytics insights with product and data science teams to support roadmap decisions.
- Integrated AI/ML APIs into analytics workflows; participated in sprint planning, standups, and retrospectives.

Product Analyst Intern | Labmentix, Bengaluru | May 2025 - Aug 2025

- Gathered product requirements and developed web features using Python, Node.js, HTML/CSS, and REST APIs.
- Used A/B testing and user-interaction data to evaluate feature improvements and refine the user experience.

Product Development & Strategy | Think And Learn (BYJU'S), Bengaluru | Jan 2020 - Mar 2022

- Planned and delivered new features for BYJU'S tablet-based online learning product, shaping the student learning experience on a large-scale edtech platform.
- Contributed features to the Disney-BYJU'S collaboration, a co-branded early-learning program for K-3 students.
- Partnered with sales and IT teams to gather and review customer feedback, channeling user insights into product decisions.

PROJECTS

AutoDoc - AI-Assisted Roadside Service Platform

- Researched customer and service-provider needs, created personas and journey maps, and built a proof of concept; used feedback and service metrics to guide feature priorities.
- Built backend APIs and a PostgreSQL database layer for booking, tracking, and analytics.

CRM System with AI-Powered Analytics

- Built dashboards tracking customer interactions, KPIs, and sales pipeline health.
- Integrated ML-based customer segmentation to inform retention strategy and sales optimization.

SKILLS

Product Management: Product strategy, PRD and spec writing, roadmap planning, OKR/KPI definition, requirements gathering, user research, feature prioritization, journey mapping, Agile/Scrum, cross-functional stakeholder collaboration, go-to-market strategy, product marketing

Fintech & Payments: UPI payments, KYC and identity verification, corporate card products, fraud detection, payment systems

AI Product Management: Generative AI tools, LLM and RAG fundamentals, prompt engineering, defining requirements for AI-driven features, evaluating model outputs and trade-offs, responsible AI, LangChain, AI coding assistants (Claude Code, GitHub Copilot)

Machine Learning: scikit-learn, XGBoost, CatBoost, predictive modeling, feature engineering, data preprocessing, model evaluation

Development: Python, SQL, JavaScript, Node.js, HTML/CSS, REST API design and integration

Data & Analytics: SQL, Power BI, Google Analytics, Pandas, NumPy, A/B testing

Databases & Tools: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Git, CI/CD, Jira

PUBLICATION

Optimizing Fraud Detection with XGBoost and CatBoost for Social Media Profiles and Payment Systems

Co-author | IEEE International Conference on Electronics and Renewable Systems (ICEARS), Feb 2025

IEEE Xplore | DOI: 10.1109/ICEARS64219.2025.10940620

EDUCATION

Master of Computer Applications (MCA) | 2023 - 2025

New Horizon College of Engineering (VTU), Bengaluru

Bachelor of Computer Applications (BCA) | 2016 - 2019

Acharya Institute of Technology (BU), Bengaluru

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified: Power BI Data Analyst Associate (PL-300)
- SQL for Data Science - UC Davis via Coursera
- Journey to Cloud: Envisioning Your Solution - IBM Skills Build